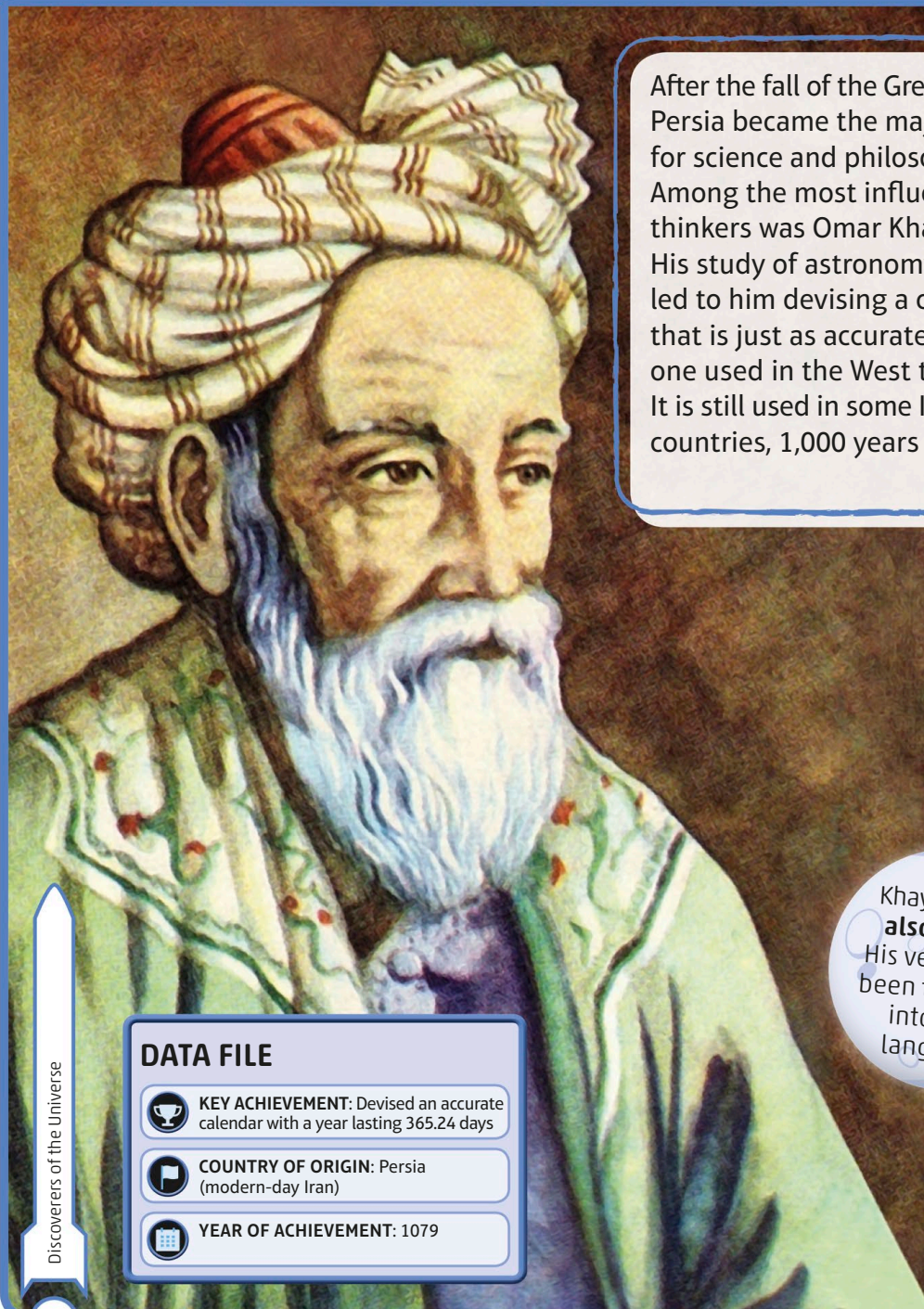


OMAR KHAYYAM

1048-1131



After the fall of the Greek Empire, Persia became the major centre for science and philosophy. Among the most influential thinkers was Omar Khayyam. His study of astronomy in 1079 led to him devising a calendar that is just as accurate as the one used in the West today. It is still used in some Islamic countries, 1,000 years later.

Khayyam **was also a poet.** His verses have been translated into many languages.

DATA FILE



KEY ACHIEVEMENT: Devised an accurate calendar with a year lasting 365.24 days



COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: Persia (modern-day Iran)



YEAR OF ACHIEVEMENT: 1079